

Japan and the World; 1868 - 1912

under Meiji restoration -> Japan's economy -> expanded -> as it engaged in trade with outside world.

Some Japanese leaders -> Believed that Japan should become a more important player in international politics - Esp. in Asia.

they even though their country -> should build an empire like Britain

many politicians -> government officials -> and military leaders -> believed that it was important for Japan to control lands -> with natural resources -> in order to grow and strengthen its economy.

This determination to become an important force on the world stage -> became clear in 1894-1895 -> when Japan went to war with China over Korea.

-> it was a stunning victory for Japan as China's forces - were no match for the modern and well trained Japanese army and navy.

With its victory -> Japan increased its influence and control in Korea.

China -> also ceded Taiwan and Liaodang Peninsula in Manchuria to Japan.

-> this alarmed another great power - Russia - because Japan was now too close to Russia's borders.

1904-1905 -> war broke out between Russia and Japan.

-> spectacular victory for Japan -> was the first time an Asian power defeated a major European power.

Japan replaced Russia as the key power in Manchuria.

1910 -> Japan annexed Korea completely and became a major power in the region.
